The new gaol exceeds the old one in strength and convenience as much as in splendour. The county, to their honour, have spared no cost. The prison was finished and occupied at the time of my visit in 1779. The debtors' rooms are seventeen feet ten inches by fifteen feet three, and nine feet ten high. At one end of their court is a workroom thirty-seven and a half feet by fourteen and a half, and twelve feet five inches high, with a fire-place and four large windows: here many were weaving garters. Over this is their free ward. At the other end of the court is their hall or kitchen, in which clauses against spirituous liquors painted on a board were hung up, and the memorial of Mrs. Herris's legacy, and a new table of fees. The felons' rooms (fifteen feet nine inches by fourteen and a half) are lofty, lined with stone and vaulted. Near their court are two rooms in a small area for the condemned. The women felons are separated; they have two rooms, a court and a pump. The courts are paved with flat stone. There is a chapel. Only one close room for an infirmary, which, being unfurnished, has never been used, though at my last visit several were sick on the floors. No bath. The felons' apartments being entirely out of sight from the gaoler's house, I beg leave to observe, that a window might be made in his kitchen, which would overlook the felons' court. The window in the debtors' apartment towards the street was highly improper, as an avenue for introducing at all times spirituous liquors, tools, etc., but it is now stopped up. The straw in the felons' rooms (as also in the bridewell) is on the floors. Such cribs or cradles as are in the hospital at Plymouth would be much more conducive to health and cleanliness. The Act for preserving the health of prisoners is not hung up: and this gaol has not been whitewashed since it was first occupied; a fault too common in new gaols. The felons are too much crowded at night, when some of their rooms are empty.

COUNTY BRIDEWELL

CHELMSFORD. On the ground-floor a large workroom, a kitchen, and a lodging-room for men: over them rooms of the same size for women: two rooms for the sick. Prisoners always kept within doors; and the rooms very offensive by the sewers.[1]

[1] Those conveniences, which delicacy forbids enlarging upon, yet which are absolutely necessary to all houses, and the situation and construction of which are of the greatest importance in prisons and other crowded buildings, have always engaged my peculiar attention: I am convinced that want of care respecting them is a principal cause of unhealthiness in many of our gaols. The reader will please to take notice, that under the words "sewers" and "drains" everything is comprehended which I had to say on this subject in my remarks on the several prisons.

Neither here nor at the gaol, are there proper drains or sewers. Mr. Ford (the keeper) told me at one of my visits that many had been ill of the gaol-fever, brought from the county gaol. His salary, £30: under-keeper's, £16: no fees. Prisoners' allowance, threepence a day; for which they have a pound and a half of bread, and a quart of small beer; and three halfpence a day further allowance to each sick prisoner. Coals, straw, brooms, etc., £4 2s. 6d. a quarter. The employment of the prisoners is spinning wool, at a penny a skein: the county has the profit. At my last visit, there were several sick and dirty objects on the floor, with little or no covering. No bath. Garnish 2s.

KENT

COUNTY GAOL AT MAIDSTONE

This gaol was erected in 1746, as appears by the date. On the first floor there are eight rooms for debtors, which open into a passage six feet two inches wide. Under these are the felons' wards near thirteen feet square: but the air and light are obstructed (the wall being three feet thick) by double wooden bars three and a half inches broad (instead of single iron ones), at the windows both of debtors and felons. There are three courts: one for debtors; one for men felons; and one for women felons. The two last are much too small (that for men which is the largest only twenty-eight feet by twenty-seven); but may be commodiously enlarged from the ground at the back of the gaol. Divine service was performed upon the stairs, but the chapel is now made commodious by the staircase being removed. The felons' night-rooms have double doors; if one of them was an iron-lattice door (as in the new gaol at Horsham) and was locked up in the daytime, the rooms would freshen and be better ventilated. There are two dungeons (twelve and a half feet square) down eleven steps for the condemned.

Felons are allowed yearly ten cauldron of coals: they have